Activity 3

Prepare a report on various steps involved in construction of a septic tank with pictures

Operation and Maintenance

The use of soap water and disinfectants such as phenol should be avoided. They are injurious to the bacterial flora in the septic tank.

The undue accumulation of sludge reduces the capacity of the septic tank and interferes with its proper working. Therefore the contents of the septic tank should be removed periodically. The cleaning period may vary from 6 months to 3 years. In any case it should not exceed 3 years.

Newly built septic tanks are first filled with water up to the outlet level and then seeded with digested sludge to carryout decomposition process.

Soak Pit

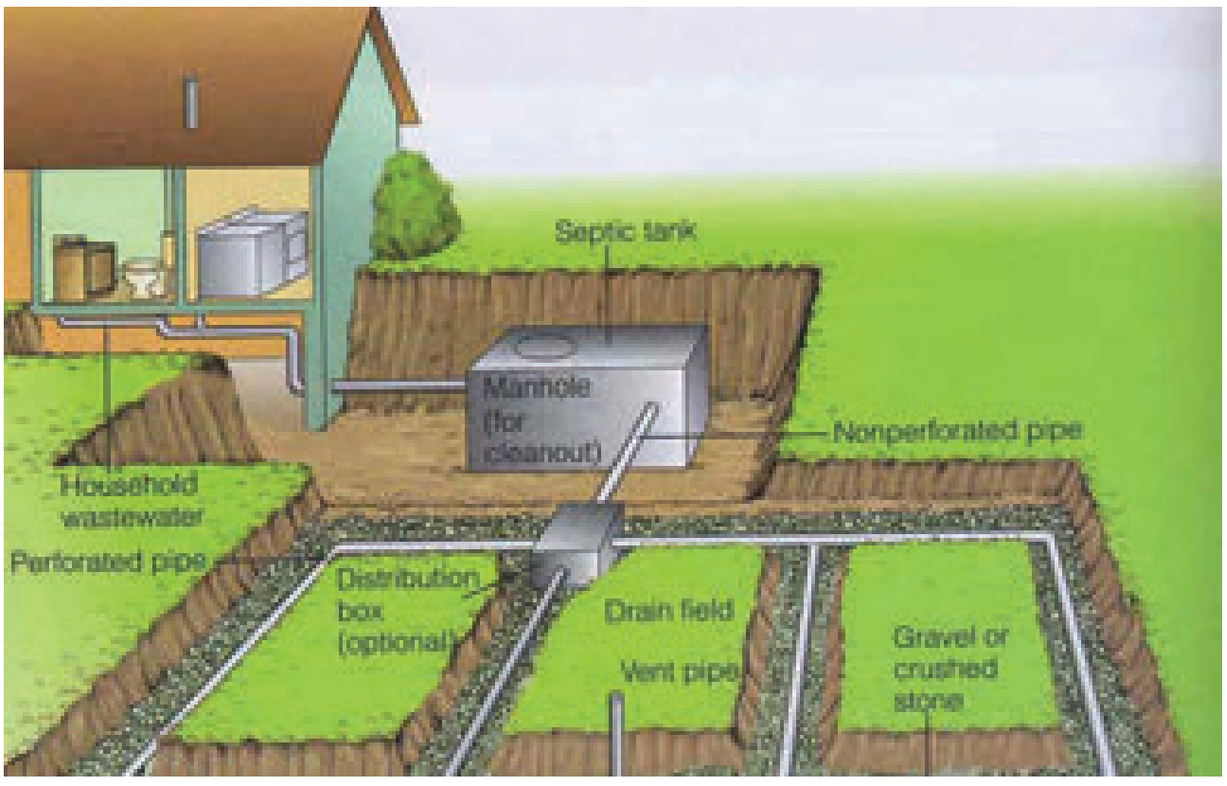
Soak pit is a covered circular or square pit. Generally the effluent from septic tank is not disposed off directly on land. For that the effluents are allowed into the soak pit and gets soaked or absorbed into the surrounding soil.

5.8. Sludge Disposal

Sludge

Sludge is the solid matter which is retained from sewage in both primary and secondary treatment units.

The sludge is hygienically unsafe. It contains pathogens and decomposes rapidly. It serves as food for saprophytic organisms. During decomposition it gives offensive odours. Therefore the sludge should be disposed off as early as possible.



Flow Diagram of Sewage disposal

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